HSE Field Guide | SERNEM Pro Series | Site validation required

SERNEM Health and Safety Resources

HOT WORK CRITICAL SAFETY RULES

Authorize • Control Combustibles • Prevent Fire

OSHA 1910.252(a)(2)(iii)(B)
OSHA · US scope · Verify local requirements separately

Document · EN
SRN-HW-001
Revision 1.0

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SERNEM · Check Before Starting

Pre-Job Check

- ✓ Hot work permit
- ✓ Required gas testing
- ✓ Combustible control
- ✓ Fire watch
- ✓ Suitable extinguisher
- ✓ Spark barriers
- ✓ Post-work watch

01 — REQUIRED IF

Hot Work Permit

Applies when: A permit system requires it

- ✓ Verify a valid hot-work permit where the permit system requires one.
- ✓ Confirm the work area and scope match the authorization.
- ✓ Stop work and reassess the permit if conditions change.

02 — REQUIRED

Remove Combustibles

- ✓ Move combustible materials to a safe distance.
- ✓ Protect immovable materials with fire-resistant covers.
- ✓ Check floors, openings and opposite surfaces for spark exposure.

03 — REQUIRED IF

Atmospheric Testing

Applies when: Atmospheric hazards or permit conditions require testing

- ✓ Test the atmosphere before work where required.
- ✓ Verify oxygen, flammable-gas and toxic hazards.
- ✓ Use continuous or periodic monitoring when conditions may change.

04 — REQUIRED IF

Fire Watch

Applies when: OSHA fire-watch criteria or site risk applies

- ✓ Where OSHA watch criteria or site risk applies, assign a trained fire watch with no conflicting duties.
- ✓ Ensure all exposed areas remain visible and accessible.
- ✓ Authorize the fire watch to stop work and raise the alarm.

05 — REQUIRED

Firefighting Equipment

- ✓ Keep suitable extinguishing equipment immediately available.
- ✓ Verify equipment is inspected and ready for use.
- ✓ Confirm alarm and emergency communication arrangements.

06 — REQUIRED IF

Control Sparks and Heat

Applies when: Sparks or heat can affect nearby people or materials

- ✓ Confine sparks, slag and hot fragments.
- ✓ Use fire curtains or suitable barriers.
- ✓ Assess heat conduction through walls, pipes and metal surfaces.

07 — REQUIRED IF

Cylinder and Hose Safety

Applies when: Cylinders and gas hoses are used

- ✓ Keep cylinders upright, secured and away from heat.
- ✓ Inspect hoses, regulators and connections before use.
- ✓ Keep oxygen equipment free from oil and grease.

08 — REQUIRED IF

Post-Work Fire Watch

Applies when: After work requiring a fire watch

- ✓ US OSHA: maintain a fire watch for at least 30 minutes after welding/cutting requiring a watch.
- ✓ Extend the watch for stricter local rules, permits or risk; do not shorten the applicable OSHA minimum.
- ✓ Check concealed spaces and smouldering fires; do not end the watch while hazards remain.

Stop Work Now

- **Stop work immediately if a required hot-work permit is missing**
- **Stop work if flammable or explosive atmospheric hazards are uncontrolled**
- **Stop work if combustibles are not removed or protected**
- **Stop work if a required fire watch is missing or suitable extinguishing equipment is unavailable**
- **Stop work if sparks and hot fragments cannot be contained**

Critical Controls

35 ft
OSHA watch criterion: combustibles <10.7 m; spark/heat hazards beyond this distance also count

≥30 MIN
US OSHA: after welding/cutting requiring a watch; extend for stricter rules

PERMIT
Verify scope and conditions

WATCH
Trained and ready

Technical Reference · Validation Required
OSHA 1910.252(a)(2)(iii)(B)
Verify source scope and local requirements

Risk-Based PPE Selection

- **Welding Helmet** — Process-matched filter
- **Safety Glasses** — Eye protection under helmet
- **Heat-Resistant Gloves** — Heat and spatter
- **Leather Footwear** — Hot metal and sparks
- **Flame-Resistant Clothing** — Process-matched flame protection

Select PPE by risk, manufacturer and site procedure; this list is not mandatory for every task.

REQUIRED: work control · REQUIRED IF: binding when applicable · WARNING: hazard alert. Verify legal applicability separately.